

MC 451 PROJECT PROSPECTUS TEMPLATE

What you submit: one document of about one page, 250 to 400 words: a title, then six headed sections. **25 points. Due Friday, October 9, 11:59 PM, in Blackboard.**

Use these section names, in this order, as the headings of your own document. Each section below says what it is worth, the question it answers, and what it has to contain. The checks and the weaker and stronger examples for every section are on the web page: <https://aura-lab.siue.edu/v2v-hub/mc451-prospectus-template.html>.

Title: 3 points

The question it answers: could a reader guess your key variables from the title alone?

Write: one line.

Research questions or hypotheses: 4 points

The question it answers: what will your study find out, and could you answer it by examining something people made?

Write: one to three, numbered, carried over from Topic Selection and revised if your reading or your feedback changed them. Three is a maximum, not a target.

Theoretical framework: 4 points

The question it answers: which lens are you using, and what does it predict you will see in your data?

Write: two to three sentences. **It has to contain three things:** the lens, what it predicts you will see, and how that prediction connects to your questions (the reason for a hypothesis's direction, or why you chose research questions instead). One sentence usually means one of these is missing.

The gap: 4 points

The question it answers: which sources did you read, and what did they leave open that your study answers?

Write: two to three sentences, resting on the sources you annotated. **It has to contain three things:** the closest sources you annotated, what they did, and what they left open that your study answers.

Method overview: 4 points

The question it answers: what one thing will you code at a time, where does it come from, roughly how many, and how will you measure your key idea?

Write: three to four sentences. **It has to contain four things:** the unit of analysis, the data source, the rough amount, and how you will measure your key idea. Fewer than three sentences usually means one of the four is missing.

Expected contribution: 3 points

The question it answers: once you have the answer, what will someone outside this class know that they do not know now?

Write: one to two sentences. **It has to contain two things:** who learns something from your answer, and what they learn.

Timeline: 3 points

The question it answers: what will you have finished by each remaining due date?

Write: a short list by assignment, not by week, from now to the White Paper.